

iQOO Z7 Pro

Speed thrills with design skills

So iQOO is back with another smartphone in the Z-series. But is the iQOO Z7 Pro a good upgrade over its predecessor? Is the smartphone actually as good a performer as the brand is claiming it to be? Is there more to the newly-launch sub-₹25,000 than just the sleek looks and curved display? Let's find out in my review of the iQOO Z7 Pro.

DESIGN

So the design of the iQOO Z7 Pro is fantastic. The smartphone is super slim, very lightweight, and has a premium looking curved display and back panel. The smartphone looks very good and is very handy. We got the Lagoon Blue colour for this review, and I quite like how the iQOO Z7 Pro looks in this colour. There is a blue colour at the bottom, which fades into white as you move up, giving a nice sky-like feel to this back panel.

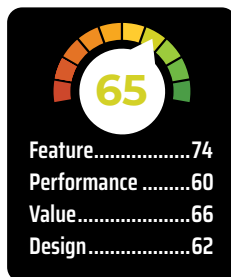
As mentioned, the iQOO Z7 Pro is also very lightweight and slim. During my review, I weighed the iQOO Z7 Pro at 194 grams, and the smartphone is just 7.36mm thin, making it very handy and pocketable. Not only does it work towards making the smartphone pocketable and handy, the slim and light profile also makes holding the smartphone for longer easy. Like even during hour-long gaming sessions, this won't make you uncomfortable since it is easy to rest the smartphone on your pinky finger.

The frame of the smartphone is plastic, but with a metal finish, which adds to the premium look. Further, the camera module is placed on the top left corner of the back panel, holding the dual cameras, and the aura light flash placed right next to the camera cutouts.

The iQOO Z7 Pro 5G, in my opinion, is one of the better looking smartphones out there. It looks super premium, has a dif-



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ferent and fun colour (there is also a black option for those who like basics), it is light, it is slim, and best of all, we also get IP52 water resistance which saves the iQOO Z7 Pro from minor splashes of water.

DISPLAY

Coming to the display, this is where iQOO has been doing surprisingly well, at least in terms of colour accuracy. Yes, this 6.78-inch AMOLED panel isn't the most vibrant out there, but in terms of representing colours as they are in real life, the iQOO Z7 Pro is pretty good. The smartphone showcased good colour accuracy and with the 120Hz refresh rate, the display also feels very responsive and slick.

Coming to brightness, we tested it using a Lux Meter, and the iQOO Z7 Pro showed a maximum luminance of 847 nits, which is pretty good for any smartphone. Now, while the brightness is good in terms of the numbers it puts out, I found the sunlight visibility to be a bit low. In very bright sunlight, the screen looked

kind of dull and wasn't feeling very vibrant. The minimum brightness using the Lux Meter came out to be just 7 nits.

Since iQOO has used an AMOLED panel, we get punchier colours and darker blacks all around. The colours are accurate. I put this to test to a colour checker test and the iQOO Z7 Pro showcased fantastic colour accuracy with an average DeltaE of 2.0 in the RGB colour profile. In the grey-scale test also, the smartphone showed a good RGB balance, tracking a Gamma of 2.2, which is very good for a smartphone, since mobile displays are tuned towards Gamma 2.2.

Overall, this is a very good display on the iQOO Z7 Pro. It is accurate in colour, it is responsive and vibrant. Just the sunlight visibility is not as good as I expected it to be, but that is something many people can easily get over.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, the iQOO Z7 Pro comes with a special focus on performance. Of course, this is an iQOO phone so the major focus is on performance and gaming. In terms of performance, the smartphone remains true to its price-to-performance DNA. We get a MediaTek Dimensity 7200 chip paired with up to 8GB of RAM. Now, this is a ₹22,000 smartphone and it comes with a 4nm chipset. Before even testing it, I knew that the iQOO Z7 Pro will be one of the most powerful smartphones in this range.

That guess was spot on, as the smartphone scored an impressive 713216 points on AnTuTu, coming ahead of much more expensive products like the OnePlus Nord CE 3, the Moto Edge 40, Realme 11 Pro+ and the likes. On Geekbench, the iQOO Z7 Pro beats these smartphones in the single-core test, but in the multi-core test, the iQOO Z7 Pro comes behind the Moto Edge 40 and the OnePlus Nord CE 3. Furthermore, in other CPU-based tests, the iQOO Z7 Pro, as usual, performed well. Not the best in sub-₹30k smartphones, but right up there with some of the most powerful in this bracket.

Coming to GPU-based tests, the iQOO Z7 Pro again beats smartphones like the OnePlus Nord CE 3, Moto Edge 40, Realme